



Directory > R2 > Buckets >

Bucket locks

 Copy page



Bucket locks

Bucket locks prevent the deletion and overwriting of objects in an R2 bucket for a specified period — or indefinitely. When enabled, bucket locks enforce retention policies on your objects, helping protect them from accidental or premature deletions.

Get started with bucket locks

Before getting started, you will need:

- An existing R2 bucket. If you do not already have an existing R2 bucket, refer to [Create buckets](#).

- (API only) An API token with [permissions](#) to edit R2 bucket configuration.

Enable bucket lock via dashboard

1. In the Cloudflare dashboard, go to the **R2 object storage** page.

Go to **Overview** 

2. Select the bucket you would like to add bucket lock rule to.
3. Switch to the **Settings** tab, then scroll down to the **Bucket lock rules** card.
4. Select **Add rule** and enter the rule name, prefix, and retention period.
5. Select **Save changes**.

Enable bucket lock via Wrangler

1. Install [npm](#).
2. Install [Wrangler, the Developer Platform CLI](#).
3. Log in to Wrangler with the [wrangler login command](#).
4. Add a bucket lock rule to your bucket by running the [r2 bucket lock add command](#).

```
npx wrangler r2 bucket lock add  
<BUCKET_NAME> [OPTIONS]
```

Alternatively, you can set the entire bucket lock configuration for a bucket from a JSON file using the [r2 bucket lock set command](#).

```
npx wrangler r2 bucket lock set  
<BUCKET_NAME> --file <FILE_PATH>
```

The JSON file should be in the format of the request body of the [put bucket lock configuration API](#).

Enable bucket lock via API

For information about getting started with the Cloudflare API, refer to [Make API calls](#). For information on required parameters and more examples of how to set bucket lock configuration, refer to the [API documentation](#).

Below is an example of setting a bucket lock configuration (a collection of rules):



```
curl -X PUT
"https://api.cloudflare.com/client/v4/accounts/<A
\
-H "Authorization: Bearer <API_TOKEN>" \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{
    "rules": [
        {
            "id": "lock-logs-7d",
            "enabled": true,
            "prefix": "logs/",
            "condition": {
                "type": "Age",
                "maxAgeSeconds": 604800
            }
        },
        {
            "id": "lock-images-indefinite",
            "enabled": true,
            "prefix": "images/",
            "condition": {
                "type": "Indefinite"
            }
        }
    ]
}
```

```
    ]  
  }'
```

This request creates two rules:

- `lock-logs-7d`: Objects under the `logs/` prefix are retained for 7 days (604800 seconds).
- `lock-images-indefinite`: Objects under the `images/` prefix are locked indefinitely.

Note

If your bucket is setup with [jurisdictional restrictions](#), you will need to pass a `cf-r2-jurisdiction` request header with that jurisdiction. For example, `cf-r2-jurisdiction: eu`.

Get bucket lock rules for your R2 bucket

Dashboard

1. In the Cloudflare dashboard, go to the **R2 object storage** page.

Go to **Overview** 

2. Select the bucket you would like to add bucket lock rule to.
3. Switch to the **Settings** tab, then scroll down to the **Bucket lock rules** card.

Wrangler

To list bucket lock rules, run the [r2 bucket lock list command](#):

```
npx wrangler r2 bucket lock list  
<BUCKET_NAME>
```

API

For more information on required parameters and examples of how to get bucket lock rules, refer to the [API documentation](#).

Remove bucket lock rules from your R2 bucket

Dashboard

1. In the Cloudflare dashboard, go to the **R2 object storage** page.

Go to **Overview** 

2. Select the bucket you would like to add bucket lock rule to.
3. Switch to the **Settings** tab, then scroll down to the **Bucket lock rules** card.
4. Locate the rule you want to remove, select the **...** icon next to it, and then select **Delete**.

Wrangler

To remove a bucket lock rule, run the [r2 bucket lock remove command](#):

```
npx wrangler r2 bucket lock remove  
<BUCKET_NAME> --id <RULE_ID>
```

API

To remove bucket lock rules via API, exclude them from your updated configuration and use the [put bucket lock configuration API](#).

Bucket lock rules

A bucket lock configuration can include up to 1,000 rules. Each rule specifies which objects it covers (via prefix) and how long those objects must remain locked. You can:

- Lock objects for a specific duration. For example, 90 days.
- Retain objects until a certain date. For example, until January 1, 2026.
- Keep objects locked indefinitely.

If multiple rules apply to the same prefix or object key, the strictest (longest) retention requirement takes precedence.

Notes

- Rules without prefix apply to all objects in the bucket.
- Rules apply to both new and existing objects in the bucket.
- Bucket lock rules take precedence over [lifecycle rules](#). For example, if a lifecycle rule attempts to delete an object at 30 days but a bucket lock rule requires it be retained for 90 days, the object will

not be deleted until the 90-day requirement is met.

Was this helpful?



Previous

← [Configure CORS](#)

Next

[Event notifications](#) →

Last updated: Sep 3, 2025

Resources

[API](#)

[New to Cloudflare?](#)

[Directory](#)

[Sponsorships](#)

[Open Source](#)

Support

[Help Center](#)

[System Status](#)

[Compliance](#)

[GDPR](#)

Company

Tools

[cloudflare.com](#)

[Cloudflare Radar](#)

[Our team](#)

[Speed Test](#)

[Careers](#)

[Is BGP Safe Yet?](#)

[RPKI Toolkit](#)

[Certificate Transparency](#)

Community

 [X](#)

 [Discord](#)

 [YouTube](#)

 [GitHub](#)

© 2025 Cloudflare, Inc. • [Privacy Policy](#) • [Terms of Use](#)

• [Report Security Issues](#) • [Trademark](#) •  [Cookie Preferences](#)